

**RESEARCH PAPER:
PROPOSAL, THESIS STATEMENT, SOURCE, CITATION STYLE, and
ANNOTATED BIBLIOGRAPHY**

A Research Proposal

In two to three paragraphs, a research proposal briefly describes your proposed topic in must describe *the site (or sites)* you would like to research, *its location*, *the type of landscape* it is (i.e. a park, urban plaza, suburban plan, a national forest, wilderness area etc., a trail system, a Native American reservation), and *the date of its initial establishment*. In addition, the proposal notes what you know thus far about the specific people, events, historical trends, ideas, concepts that will play a part in your research and analysis, and it should demonstrate that there is something to be learned from the examination you are proposing.

Many topics have the potential to be extremely broad. Therefore, when developing your proposal, choose an aspect of the topic that is specific enough to be analyzed in a 2500 to 4500 word essay (approximately 8-15 pages excluding captions, citations, and annotated bibliography). Three good ways to narrow a topic is by *theme*, *geography*, and *historical period*. NOT: The history of public gardens.

BUT: The history of public rose gardens [theme] in Chicago [geography], 1900 – 1950 [historical period].

Sample Research Proposal

My proposed research site is Fort Funston in San Francisco. It is a former military installation, now a beach and oceanfront park operated by the Golden Gate National Parks Conservancy as part of the Golden Gate National Recreation Area on the Western edge of San Francisco, South of Ocean Beach, North of Phillip Burton State Beach, and bounded on the East by Lake Merced. It is made up of the beach and the bordering 200-foot bluffs, sand dunes, bank swallow habitat, hiking and horse trails, hang gliding launch sites, aging military infrastructure, and vegetation consisting of hottentot fig and European beachgrass. The land was acquired by the federal government in 1900, and between 1917 and 1963 the U.S. military used it as an active harbor defense fortification, housing a coastal artillery battery, and later Nike missiles until the military shut it down in 1963. In 1974, the U.S. government transferred the land to the City and County of San Francisco who turned the land over to the National Parks Service in 1975 to be administered as part of the Golden Gate Recreational Area who operates it today.
(Henry Donald)

A Thesis Statement

Based on: http://www.wisc.edu/writing/Handbook/thesis_def.html (August 30, 2006)

A thesis statement is a sentence that makes an assertion about a topic and predicts how the topic will be developed. It does not simply announce a topic: *it says something about the topic.*

NOT: In this paper, I will discuss X.

BUT: X has made a significant impact on the urban expansion of San Francisco by ...

A thesis statement makes a promise to the reader about the scope, purpose, and direction of the paper. It summarizes the conclusions that the writer has reached about the topic. A thesis statement is generally located near the end of the introduction. Sometimes in a long paper, the thesis will be expressed in several sentences or an entire paragraph.

A thesis statement is focused and specific enough to be proven within the boundaries of the paper. Key words (nouns and verbs) should be specific, accurate, and indicative of the range of research, thrust of the argument of analysis, and the organization of supporting information.

For the *writer*, the thesis statement:

- Determines the paper's real focus and clarifies the relationship between ideas.
- Hangs together the evidence presented in support of the argument.
- Provides the unifying thread between pieces of information.

For the *reader*, the thesis statement:

- Serves as a "map" to follow through the paper preparing the reader to read.
- Engages the reader in the argument.
- Helps the reader spot the main ideas and grasp your argument.

You can revise your thesis statement as you are writing your essay. Writers often discover their real point and purpose in the process of putting their thoughts into words working on a text.

Sample Thesis Statement

Fairmount Park's creation and expansion during the mid-to-late nineteenth century reflected Philadelphia's struggle to reconcile industrial growth with civic health, social reform, and urban identity. Conceived initially to protect the Schuylkill River watershed from industrial pollution, the park evolved into a monumental civic project that embodied emerging ideas about public hygiene, democratic recreation, and the moral benefits of access to nature. Its design and administration demonstrate how landscape architecture became a tool for shaping urban citizenship and asserting municipal progress in an industrial age. (Martha Lazcano)

Sources

As stated in the paper assignment, your research paper must cite at least seven sources other than general texts. These can include interviews. Your sources must include three primary sources. Note that historical photographs and maps are primary sources for interpretation, as are historical newspaper articles. Andrew Matsas, the CED librarian will conduct specific tutorials focused on the research assignment during Week 6 & 7 of the course (see syllabus) and how to find sources for your topic. He will also be available for individual guidance by appointment.

Citation Style

The **Chicago footnote and bibliography** citation style is a requirement for this paper. An abbreviated guide to this citation style prepared by the UC Library is available on the class bCourse site. The full guide (Part Three: Documentation, Documentation I: Notes and Bibliography) is available online through the UC Library website at: <http://www.chicagomanualofstyle.org/16/contents.html>

An Annotated Bibliography

By Owen Williams, University of Minnesota, Crookston Library

Based on: <http://www.crk.umn.edu/library/links/annotate.htm> (August 30, 2006)

What is an annotated bibliography?

This is an organized list of sources (references cited), such as books, journals, newspapers, magazines, web pages, etc., each of which is followed by an annotation or description of each item. Compose and arrange the citations using Chicago bibliography style followed by the annotation. (see examples below) Include only directly significant information and write concisely. *An annotated bibliography is required for both the progress report and final paper.*

Annotations may consist of all or part of the following items:

- The content of the item and its usefulness for your research
- Limitations that the item, what it does not provide
- What kind of a source it is, i.e. academic research, tourist brochure, government document, etc.
- Evaluate which the facts or data the source uses and the reliability of the source
- Discuss any conclusions the source provides

The purpose of an annotated bibliography is:

- A review of the literature on a particular subject
- Provide examples of the types of sources you have used in your paper
- Illustrate the quality of research that you have done

Sample Annotated Bibliography (NOTE FORMAT!)

Brown, Theodore M. "Greenough, Pain, Emerson, and the Organic Aesthetic." *Journal of Aesthetics and Art Criticism*. 14 (March 1956): 304-317.

Summary of these artists' aesthetics, which will help guide reading of primary text by both Emerson and Greenough and what aspects of this aesthetic Cleveland represented in his own work.

Cleveland, H.W.S. "The Influence of Parks on the Character of Children." *American Park and Outdoor Art Association*. 2 (1898): 105-108

Cleveland's perspective on social role/service of landscape, and responsibility of design to enrich this experience.

Cleveland, H.W.S. *The Aesthetic Development of the United Cites of St. Paul and Minneapolis*. Minneapolis: A.C. Bausman, 1888.

Essential primary source of plan and descriptions of the St. Paul and Minneapolis park systems.

Cleveland, H.W.S. *Landscape Architecture: As Applied to the Wants of the West*. Pittsburgh: University of Pittsburgh Press, 1965. (Reprinted from original edition published Chicago: Jansen, McClurg, 1873).

Key primary source of insight into Cleveland's design philosophy and practice that guided the development of the St. Paul and Minneapolis park systems.

Greenough, Horatio. *Form and Function: Remarks on Art, Design and Architecture*. ed. Harold L. Small. Berkeley: University of California Press, 1957.

Primary material for understanding the organic aesthetic, and for comparison with Cleveland's work. Will help put Cleveland in context of the American art world of the 19th century.

Upton, Dell. "Nature." *Architecture in the United States*. New York: Oxford University Press, 1998. 107-148.

Chapter in survey text on American architectural design that discusses nature as a fundamental model of form and aesthetics in the American environment. Provides a larger social and cultural context in which to examine Cleveland's principles of design.

Writing support services available on campus:

Student Learning Center

<https://slc.berkeley.edu/writing>

The Student Learning Center offers a wide variety of online and in person support for academic writing. Drop in and by-appointment tutoring in writing for all undergraduate courses. Special services are offered for non-native speakers of English.

Graduate Writing Center

<https://grad.berkeley.edu/partner/graduate-writing-center/>

The Graduate Writing Center assists graduate students in the development of academic skills necessary to successfully complete their graduate programs and prepare for future faculty and professional positions. This unit offers workshops on topics such as academic writing, grant writing, dissertation writing, editing, and preparing articles for publication, in addition to writing groups and individual consultations on these topics for graduate students.

Athletic Study Center

<https://asc.berkeley.edu/academicsupport>

The Athletic Study Center's Academic Support Services include individual tutoring and skill building, study groups and workshops all with the goal of helping to build academic competence and confidence and an institutional sense of belonging.

Berkeley On-Line Writing Resources

<https://slc.berkeley.edu/writing-worksheets-and-other-writing-resources> These on-line writing labs offers students writing tips, grammar guides, citation guides, bibliographies, and links to writing resources.